

Technical-Intelligence Digest

Week of 2026-06-27 · A330-300 · A321neo · A350-900 · A350-1000 · 777-300ER

DIRECTLY FLEET-RELEVANT

FAA AD 2025-25-07: GE90 HPT stage 1/2 disk replacement for iron-inclusion powder-metal defect (effective Feb 6, 2026) VERIFIED [carried-over developing event]

777-300ER · 2026-01-02

What happened: FAA AD 2025-25-07 (docket FAA-2025-1364), published 2 January 2026 and effective 6 February 2026, requires replacement of GE90-90B/-94B/-110B1/-115B HPT stage 1 and stage 2 disks identified in AD Table 1 or referenced GE service-bulletin tables, due to a manufacturing process that may have introduced iron inclusion into the powder-metal material, risking premature fracture and uncontained failure. GE90-115B powers the CX 777-300ER fleet.

Technical detail: AD FAA AD 2025-25-07 [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-02-06 [\[source\]](#); HPT stage 1/2 disks manufactured from powder metal material suspected to contain iron inclusion, reducing fatigue life and raising risk of premature fracture / uncontained failure..

“The FAA is issuing this AD to prevent premature fracture and uncontained failure of the HPT stage 1 disks and HPT stage 2 disks.” — Airworthiness Directives; General Electric Company Engines, FAA AD 2025-25-07, 2026-01-02 [\[source\]](#)

FAA AD 2025-25-12: A350 flight-control software update closes out FCRM hydraulic-fluid contamination risk (effective Jan 13, 2026) VERIFIED [carried-over developing event]

A350-900, A350-1000 · 2025-12-29

What happened: FAA AD 2025-25-12 (Amendment 39-23220, docket FAA-2025-5390), published 29 December 2025 and effective 13 January 2026, requires Airbus A350-941/-1041 operators to install Flight Control and Guidance System software standards PRIM P14.1.3 and SEC S14.1.2, permanently closing out a risk of loss of control of an outboard aileron (and, by shared design, elevator/rudder) surfaces caused by hydraulic fluid contaminating an electronic card in the Flight Control Remote Module. It supersedes interim AD 2025-13-12 (July 2025).

Technical detail: AD FAA AD 2025-25-12 [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-01-13 [\[source\]](#); Hydraulic fluid contaminated an electronic card of the Flight Control Remote Module (FCRM), which could cause loss of control of an outboard aileron surface.; Software fix is positioned as the permanent mitigation, replacing the interim hardware-replacement program required by superseded AD 2025-13-12..

“Loss of control of an outboard aileron surface due to hydraulic fluid contaminating an electronic card of the flight control remote module.” — Airworthiness Directives; Airbus SAS Airplanes, FAA AD 2025-25-12, 2025-12-29 [\[source\]](#)

EASA Emergency AD 2026-0119-E: A380 wing mid-spar crack inspections (Emirates/Qantas) — effective June 24, 2026 VERIFIED

· 2026-06-22

What happened: EASA issued Emergency AD 2026-0119-E (issued 22 June 2026, effective 24 June 2026) covering Airbus A380-841/-842/-861 wing mid-spar inspections, published without the normal consultation process due to urgency. Trade press reports it follows a prior directive (2025-0280) on aircraft returning from storage and affects 16 specific aircraft (15 Emirates, 1 Qantas), though the EASA portal page itself did not display the detailed unsafe-condition text or MSN list (contained only in the PDF attachment).

Technical detail: EAD EASA AD 2026-0119-E [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-06-24 [source]; Reported (trade press, not confirmed from the AD's full text): cracking discovered at the wing mid-spar, found during follow-up review of a prior storage-related inspection directive. EASA portal summary page did not display the underlying unsafe-condition narrative or MSN list (held only in the gated PDF attachment)..

“The results of the safety assessment have indicated the need for immediate publication and notification, without the full consultation process” — EASA AD 2026-0119-E — Wings, Wing Mid Spars, Inspection, 2026-0119-E, 2026-06-22 [source]

Read-across to fleet: Airbus widebody structural/design lineage is generic context; the A380-specific wing mid-spar issue has no direct part commonality with CX's A330/A350 wing-box designs.

FAA AD 2026-12-06 (effective June 30, 2026): Trent 1000 HPT blade failure risk — Trent family read-across VERIFIED

OTHER TRENT-POWERED WIDEBODIES, 787 · 2026-06-15

What happened: FAA adopted AD 2026-12-06 (Amendment 39-23376, docket FAA-2026-4655), published 15 June 2026 and effective 30 June 2026, for 13 Rolls-Royce Deutschland Trent 1000 series engine variants (-AE3 through -R3) due to premature high-pressure turbine blade failure risk despite existing inspection/life-limit requirements, which could cause loss of thrust control and loss of the airplane.

Technical detail: AD FAA AD 2026-12-06 [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-06-30 [source]; Premature failure of high-pressure turbine (HPT) blades despite existing inspection and life-limit requirements..

“The unsafe condition, if not addressed, could result in failure of one or more engines, loss of thrust control, and loss of the airplane.” — Airworthiness Directives; Rolls-Royce Deutschland Ltd & Co KG Engines, FAA AD 2026-12-06, 2026-06-15 [source]

Read-across to fleet: Trent 1000 is a Rolls-Royce Trent-family engine; HPT-blade-failure risk and the manufacturing/inspection scrutiny it implies are relevant read-across for Trent 700 and Trent XWB on the CX fleet, though this AD does not apply to CX's own engines.

FAA AD 2025-26-04: PW1122G-JM through PW1431GH-JM fuel hose clamp / fan blade fire risk (effective Feb 17, 2026) — read-across VERIFIED [carried-over developing event]

A321NEO · 2026-01-12

What happened: FAA AD 2025-26-04 (Amendment 39-23226, docket FAA-2025-0480), published 12 January 2026 and effective 17 February 2026, addresses Pratt & Whitney geared-turbofan engines (PW1122G-JM through PW1431GH-JM model range, encompassing the PW1100G-JM/PW1400G-JM families) after multiple reports of fan blade fracture events, three resulting in an engine under-cowl or pool fire. Requires removal of a loop cushion clamp (P/N ST1540-06) within 30 days and replacement of thermal management system clevis mounts at next shop visit. CX's own A321neo fleet uses LEAP-1A, not PW1100G, so this is read-across only.

Technical detail: AD FAA AD 2025-26-04 [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-02-17 [source]; Multiple fan blade fracture events, three resulting in engine under-cowl or pool fire..

“Multiple reports of fan blade fracture events, three of which resulted in an engine under cowl fire or pool fire.” — Airworthiness Directives; Pratt & Whitney Division Engines, FAA AD 2025-26-04, 2026-01-12 [source]

Read-across to fleet: PW1100G is a read-across engine for the A321neo; CX's own A321neo fleet uses LEAP-1A.

FAA AD 2025-24-51 / EASA AD 2025-0268-E: A320-family ELAC software fix for solar-radiation pitch event (effective Jan 6, 2026) VERIFIED [carried-over developing event]

A321NEO · 2025-11-28

What happened: Following an Airbus A320 uncommanded, limited pitch-down event attributed to intense solar radiation corrupting an Elevator Aileron Computer (ELAC), EASA issued emergency AD 2025-0268-E (effective 29 Nov 2025) and the FAA mirrored it with emergency AD 2025-24-51 (Amendment 39-23223, docket FAA-2025-5395), published 5 January 2026 and effective 6 January 2026, both requiring replacement/modification of affected ELACs. The FAA AD's effectivity list explicitly includes A321-251NX/-252NX/-253NX/-271NX/-272NX — the CX A321neo configuration family.

Technical detail: AD FAA AD 2025-24-51 [VERIFIED — primary source] — effective 2026-01-06 [source]; Intense solar radiation interfered with ELAC processing, causing an uncommanded, limited pitch-down event; malfunction of the affected ELAC could cause uncommanded elevator movement exceeding structural capability..

“The unsafe condition could lead to an uncommanded elevator movement that may result in exceeding the aircraft's structural capability.” — Airworthiness Directives; Airbus SAS Airplanes, FAA AD 2025-24-51, 2026-01-05 [source]

Read-across to fleet: Directly involves the A321neo's ELAC flight-control computer family (variants -251NX/-252NX/-253NX/-271NX/-272NX explicitly listed in the FAA AD); CX's own A321neo fleet's ELAC software standard should be checked against the AD.

JAL A350-1000 diverts to Keflavik over right-engine oil system malfunction (Trent XWB-97), June 14 2026 REPORTED

A350-1000 · 2026-06-14

What happened: A Japan Airlines Airbus A350-1000 (JA02WJ), operating flight JL43 Tokyo Haneda-London Heathrow with 222 passengers and 17 crew, diverted to Keflavik, Iceland on 14 June 2026 after the crew identified a right-hand engine oil system malfunction while over Greenland at FL370, landing safely on runway 01. The aircraft is powered by Trent XWB-97, the same engine variant used on CX's own A350-1000 fleet. No associated AD/SB has surfaced.

Read-across to fleet: Same aircraft type and engine variant (A350-1000 / Trent XWB-97) operated by Cathay Pacific; an oil-system malfunction on this engine type warrants monitoring for any related OEM bulletin.

NTSB preliminary report (DCA26FA194): United 767-400 (Flight 169) struck light pole on approach to Newark UNVERIFIED

767 · 2026-06-04

What happened: United Airlines Flight 169, a Boeing 767-400ER (N77066) from Venice to Newark, struck a light pole over the New Jersey Turnpike on approach to runway 29 on 3 May 2026 (debris hit a tractor-trailer, minor injury to the driver); the aircraft sustained substantial fuselage damage. NTSB released a preliminary report on 4 June 2026 under docket DCA26FA194, finding the aircraft was below the normal glidepath, with the first officer warning the captain the aircraft was 'slow' and 'a little low' shortly before impact.

Technical detail: NTSB docket DCA26FA194 — Preliminary Report [UNVERIFIED — reference exists, text not accessed] [[source](#)]; Reported (trade press characterization of NTSB preliminary findings): aircraft remained below normal glide path for the final approach segment; first officer warned the captain the aircraft was slow and low shortly before impact..

Read-across to fleet: 767 is a Boeing widebody peer type; approach-energy-management and CRM lessons are relevant to 777 line operations even though airframe-specific systems differ.

MAJOR INDUSTRY EVENTS

NTSB UPS MD-11 (Flight 2976, docket DCA26MA024) investigative hearing — May 19-20, 2026: aft-pylon bearing fatigue findings VERIFIED [carried-over developing event]

· 2026-05-19

What happened: NTSB held a two-day investigative hearing (19-20 May 2026, docket DCA26MA024, confirmed on [nts.gov](https://www.nts.gov)) into the 4 November 2025 crash of UPS Flight 2976, an MD-11F that lost its No.1 engine/pylon on takeoff from Louisville, killing 3 crew and 11 on the ground. Trade press reporting on the hearing describes fatigue cracking in an aft pylon spherical bearing (P/N S00399-1), prior bearing-failure incidents referenced in a 2011 Boeing service letter (MD-11-SL-54-104-A), and Boeing testimony that the bearing should have been classified as a Principal Structural Element at original certification. The FAA's emergency AD grounded MD-11/DC-10/MD-10 variants in November 2025; that grounding was eased in May 2026 per trade press.

Technical detail: NTSB docket DCA26MA024 — Investigative Hearing [VERIFIED — primary source] [\[source\]](#); AD FAA emergency AD (MD-11/DC-10/MD-10 grounding, Nov 2025) [UNVERIFIED — reference exists, text not accessed]; Reported (trade press characterization): fatigue cracking in the bearing race propagated until overstress fracture of both lugs, shifting load and allowing engine/pylon separation.; Reported (trade press characterization of hearing testimony): Boeing staff acknowledged the failed aft pylon spherical bearing should have been classified as a Principal Structural Element during original MD-11 certification..

“The three crewmembers aboard the airplane were killed. Eleven people on the ground were killed and another 23 injured.” — Investigative Hearing: UPS Flight 2976 Crash During Takeoff, DCA26MA024, 2026-05-19 [\[source\]](#)

Read-across to fleet: Classic major industry event — pylon/engine-mount structural integrity and the OEM-service-letter-vs-mandatory-AD gap is a read-across theme for all CX fleet types, even though CX operates no MD-11/DC-10.

STANDING WATCH

Forward-looking and background items — not this week's verified incident intelligence.

ON THE HORIZON

FAA NPRM (docket FAA-2026-1339): proposed AD for 777 MLG support beam crack inspections [PROPOSED — not yet final] [carried-over developing event]

777-300ER · 2026-02-25

What happened: FAA published an NPRM (docket FAA-2026-1339, Project Identifier AD-2025-01162-T) on 25 February 2026 proposing a new AD for Boeing 777-200/-200LR/-300/-300ER/777F airplanes after reports of cracking on the MLG support beam lower stabilizer brace aft fitting, referencing Boeing Alert Requirements Bulletin 777-57A0128 RB. Comment period closed 13 April 2026; no final rule located as of verification.

Technical detail: NPRM FAA-2026-1339; Project Identifier AD-2025-01162-T [PROPOSED — not yet final] [\[source\]](#); Cracks found on the MLG support beam lower stabilizer brace aft fitting lower flange attachment holes, referenced in Boeing ARB 777-57A0128 RB.; FAA states uncorrected cracking could lead to MLG collapse during takeoff/landing/ground operations..

“A collapsed MLG during takeoff, landing, or ground operations, if not addressed, could result in loss of control of the airplane.” — *Airworthiness Directives; The Boeing Company Airplanes (NPRM), FAA-2026-1339, 2026-02-25* [\[source\]](#)

FAA NPRM (docket FAA-2026-3873): A330/A340 flightcrew oxygen supply insufficient for ETOPS-180 with 4 crew [PROPOSED — not yet final] [carried-over developing event]

A330-300 · 2026-04-29

What happened: FAA published an NPRM (docket FAA-2026-3873, Project Identifier MCAI-2025-00197-T) on 29 April 2026 proposing an AD for Airbus A330-200/-300 airplanes modified by STC ST04038NY, where a single-cylinder flightcrew oxygen system would be insufficient under all circumstances for ETOPS-180 operations with four flightcrew members. Comment period closed 15 June 2026; no final rule located as of verification. Only relevant if CX's A330-300 fleet carries this specific STC.

Technical detail: NPRM FAA-2026-3873; Project Identifier MCAI-2025-00197-T [PROPOSED — not yet final] [\[source\]](#); Insufficient flightcrew oxygen supply for ETOPS-180 diversion time with 4 flightcrew, for airplanes equipped with a single-cylinder oxygen system per STC ST04038NY..

Sources & Confidence: 9 items — 7 VERIFIED, 1 REPORTED, 1 UNVERIFIED. Public-internet sources only; gated OEM documents marked UNVERIFIED.